

Dish Machine Sanitizer Checks

Owner & Station

- Document owner: Grace Liu (FOH Lead)
- Station: Front of House

Purpose & Key Limits

- Keep guests and staff safe by ensuring the low-temp dish machine sanitizes correctly every time.
- Low-temp machine uses chlorine sanitizer at 50–100 ppm.
- Final rinse water must reach 120°F minimum.
- Test with chlorine strips at the start of every shift and after changing the chemical jug.

Tools and Set-Up

- Chlorine test strips (labeled for 10–200 ppm range).
- Clean, dry cup or ladle for collecting final rinse water.
- Towels for drying hands and surfaces.
- PPE: dish gloves and eye protection when handling chemicals.
- Access to the 3-compartment sink as the backup warewashing method.

When to Test and What to Record

- At the start of every shift.
- After changing the chemical jug.
- Any time plates/glasses smell like bleach, look cloudy, or come out wet and cool to the touch.
- When the machine has been idle for an extended period.
- Record ppm, rinse temperature, time, initials, and any actions taken.

Sanitizer & Temperature Quick Reference

Parameter	Target/Limit	How to Check	Action if Out of Range
Chlorine sanitizer (ppm)	50–100 ppm	Chlorine test strip	Stop, re-prime chemical line, retest; if still low, switch to 3-compartment sink and open a ticket
Final rinse water	120°F minimum	Machine gauge or	Pause use, run 2–3

temp		cup + strip	cycles to heat; if still low, switch to 3-compartment sink and open a ticket
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Start-of-Shift Testing Procedure

1. Power on the dish machine and let it run two empty cycles to warm and charge lines.
2. Place a clean rack through a full wash and sanitize cycle.
3. During the final rinse, catch a small sample of rinse water in a clean cup.
4. Dip a chlorine test strip per strip instructions (fully wet; do not swirl).
5. Shake off excess water and compare color promptly at the instructed read time.
6. Read the machine's final rinse temperature from the gauge (or verify with the sample if the gauge is unreadable).
7. Accept the machine only if chlorine is 50–100 ppm and final rinse is 120°F minimum.
8. Log results with ppm, temperature, time, and your initials.

Chemical Change and Priming

- Change the chemical jug immediately if levels look low, the pickup tube is drawing air, or ppm tests below 50.
- To change and prime:
 1. Put on gloves and eye protection.
 2. Remove the pickup tube from the empty chemical jug. Keep the tip clean; do not set it on the floor.
 3. Place the tube firmly into the new chemical jug. Ensure the tip reaches the bottom.
 4. Run the machine for 2–3 consecutive cycles with an empty rack to pull sanitizer through the line.
 5. Test again with chlorine strips. Chlorine must be 50–100 ppm.
 6. If below 50 ppm: stop, re-prime the chemical line, retest. If it still fails, switch to the 3-compartment sink and open a ticket.

Troubleshooting and What to Do If

- If below 50 ppm:
 - Stop sending racks.
 - Re-seat the pickup tube; make sure it is not kinked and is fully submerged.
 - Re-prime the chemical line by running 2–3 cycles; retest.

- If it still fails, switch to the 3-compartment sink and open a ticket. Notify the MOD.
- If above 100 ppm:
 - Do not use the machine until corrected. Check for a mis-set chemical feed or cross-connection. Open a ticket and notify the MOD. Use the 3-compartment sink.
- If final rinse is below 120°F:
 - Run 2–3 empty cycles to allow heating; verify incoming hot water valves are open.
 - If still low, stop use, switch to the 3-compartment sink, and open a ticket.
- Visual/smell cues:
 - Strong bleach odor, etched glassware, or rapid corrosion on racks suggests over-concentration; test immediately.
 - Greasy feel or food soil on items suggests under-concentration or low temperature; test and correct.
- Strip handling:
 - Keep test strips dry and capped. Do not touch the pad. Expired or wet strips give false results.

3-Compartment Sink Backup (When Machine Fails)

9. Set up: Wash, rinse, sanitize, air-dry.
10. Sanitize basin: Fill with warm water; add chlorine to reach 50–100 ppm. Verify with chlorine strips.
11. Wash: Hot, soapy water; scrub all surfaces.
12. Rinse: Clear water to remove suds.
13. Sanitize: Fully submerge items for the strip's stated contact time; maintain 50–100 ppm.
14. Air-dry: Racks only; no towels.
15. Recheck sanitizer ppm every hour or if the sink is heavily used; adjust as needed.

Clean-up, Storage, and Safety

- Never mix chemicals. Keep chemical jugs upright and capped.
- Wipe up spills immediately; rinse and dry floors to avoid slips.
- Store chlorine test strips above splash zone, in a dry, closed container.
- Wash hands after handling chemicals.

Communication and Accountability

- Log all tests and actions. Incomplete logs = task not done.
- Open a ticket immediately for any machine failure and note that FOH has switched to the 3-compartment sink.
- Tell the MOD and Prep about the switch so rack flow adjusts.
- Grace Liu (FOH Lead) reviews logs and follows up on open tickets and retraining needs.